KEYNOTE ADDRESS:

INTERACTION IN THE WORLD OF BEATS

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ABSTRACT

Most art music eschews simple, visceral rhythms. A rock beat in electro-acoustic concert music is unheard of except as social commentary or irony. Research in our field has largely accepted this aesthetic direction. Computer accompaniment, conducting, improvising, and other interactive systems assume that tempo (if any) is meant to be manipulated expressively. As a consequence, computer music technology comes up lacking in the world of beats, characterized by a steady tempo, where rhythm and structure are tightly coupled. My vision is to create new interactive systems that accept the premise of beats and exploit that structure to the fullest. I will discuss how beats alter the very nature of musical interaction. I hope to engage student, amateur, and professional musicians at all levels in new conceptualizations of electro-acoustic music production and control. There is a tremendous potential for creative new directions and performance practices to emerge.